

Report to the Parliament of the Brussels-Capital Region and the Chamber of representatives:

The Metro 3 project in the Brussels-Capital Region



The Belgian Court of Audit examined the implementation of the Metro 3 project carried out by STIB-MIVB (public transport operator in the Brussels-Capital Region) and Beliris (public construction body in the Brussels-Capital Region).

The Court identified weaknesses in the project management and in the compliance with public procurement legislation. These weaknesses led to significant cost and time overruns. This situation will delay the achievement of the objectives of reducing car traffic and optimising the complementarity between the various modes of public transport, as defined by the Brussels-Capital Region.

The Court recommended that:

- the quality of the ex ante evaluation of major infrastructure projects be improved and the coordination of strategic investment priorities in transport infrastructure in the Brussels-Capital Region be guaranteed;
- the steering of these projects be strengthened by publishing progress reports describing the actual progress made on each project;
- the various financing options for major infrastructure projects be analysed, taking into account the sustainability of the entity's public finances, from the project design stage onwards.

Finally, the Court recommended that, using a proven cost-benefit method, the financial viability (including financing conditions and acceptable profitability thresholds) of the Metro 3 project be reassessed by covering its entire life cycle and taking into account its socioeconomic and environmental impacts.